

CLEAN SLATE

ASHESH SHAH



◀ REWIND

CELEBRATED ABROAD

Kiran Bedi, India's first woman IPS officer and a former all-Asian tennis champion, won the Magsaysay Award for her efforts in rehabilitating criminals in Tihar Jail. But that didn't prevent her being shunted from one insignificant posting to another.

SHARAD SAXENA



FIRST CUT

On October 15, the PSLV (Polar Satellite Launch Vehicle) made a successful launch. It became a work-

horse launch vehicle for ISRO, and since then has put eight Indian remote sensing satellites and six satellites for foreign customers in orbit.

The ancient scourge of bubonic plague laid its deathly grip on Surat in Gujarat and Beed in Maharashtra in September and October. The panic was widespread—within four days of the outbreak, over four lakh people, or 12 per cent of the city's population, fled the city carrying with them the disease. A case of the plague was reported from Bangalore within a day of the outbreak in Surat. Modern medicine kept the death toll to 54, but only just, considering 1,500 people were infected within the first week itself.